Crude stays above $90 without US-Iran progress

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【メール原文】

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Brent unlikely to slip below $90 without US-Iran progress

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A negotiated settlement that would reopen the Strait of Hormuz remains unlikely, even as the risk of imminent escalation has receded.
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Rising Middle East flows and increased Western Hemisphere exports have pushed the crude market into a slight surplus.
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However, the risk of Iranian attacks on shipping remains high, while rising Chinese imports are adding pressure on demand, suggesting that oil prices will remain elevated.

Despite crude selloff, US-Iran deal remains unlikely. Brent crude has fallen steeply over the past two weeks, from above $115 per barrel to the low $90s as of Monday, partly because expectations have risen for an imminent US-Iran agreement that would reopen the Strait of Hormuz. However, such a deal remains unlikely. Despite ongoing mediation, neither the US nor Iran has shifted its negotiating position.

Rising flows and weaker demand have produced a market surplus. As Eurasia Group noted (see: Markets face prolonged fuel squeeze even as crude flows recover , 6 November 2026), the crude market is likely in a state of slight oversupply. The main driver is the increase in crude flows from the Middle East, where average exports have risen from 10 million barrels per day (bpd) at the end of August to 18-20 million bpd in early November. As a result, Brent spot prices have fallen sharply, with the prompt price falling slightly below the Brent front month, suggesting that supply is ample.

Increasing Western Hemisphere supply will continue into 2027. With Middle East flows disrupted, producers outside the region have ramped up output. The US, Guyana, Venezuela, and Brazil have collectively increased exports by more than 1.5 million bpd this year.

High risk and rising Chinese imports suggest an elevated floor for prices. Despite the recent selloff, prices are unlikely to fall below $90 per barrel for Brent without more durable signs of de-escalation and a US-Iran deal. At the same time, risks to shipping remain high, as Iran continues to attack vessels transiting the Strait of Hormuz. On the demand side, China’s seaborne imports continue to recover and will likely exceed 9 million bpd in November, a sharp increase from their summer lows.

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